

PROSPER AWUNI

Threat Detection Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Kusto Query Language (KQL) | MITRE ATT&CK | Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR)

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Threat Detection Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience building and maintaining detection capabilities across large enterprise environments. I have deep practical expertise in Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Kusto Query Language (KQL) for detection authoring and threat hunting, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Office 365, CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), and attacker Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (TTPs) mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I also have practical experience with Azure cloud logging, identity event telemetry, and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation. I am passionate about building detection coverage that genuinely surfaces real threats, and I am seeking a hybrid or remote permanent role where I can apply this detection engineering expertise at scale.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (Kusto Query Language (KQL)), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), detection rule authoring, analytics rule lifecycle management
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR/XDR):** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI)
- **Threat Hunting and Intelligence:** MITRE ATT&CK-aligned hunting hypotheses, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, proactive threat hunting, TTP analysis
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks and automation rules, SOAR playbook development and optimisation
- **Cloud and Identity Telemetry:** Microsoft Azure cloud logging, Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory (Azure AD)), Conditional Access audit logs, Azure Monitor
- **Email and Collaboration Security:** Microsoft Defender for Office 365, Mimecast email security gateway
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting for detection automation and incident response tooling
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST SP 800-61 Incident Response, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Own the detection engineering function for the university, authoring, testing, and maintaining Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules within Microsoft Sentinel across an 8,000-user environment, aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques.
- Conduct regular proactive threat hunts using Microsoft Sentinel KQL queries and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, hypothesis-driven and mapped to current adversary TTPs, surfacing threats not captured by existing detection coverage.
- Configure and maintain the Microsoft Defender suite, including Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Identity (MDI), tuning detection policies and alert thresholds to minimise false positives while preserving detection fidelity.
- Develop and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks within Microsoft Sentinel, automating triage and initial response actions for high-frequency alert categories to improve analyst efficiency.
- Monitor and ingest Azure cloud and identity log sources into Microsoft Sentinel, ensuring comprehensive telemetry coverage across Azure Active Directory (Azure AD / Entra ID), Azure Monitor, and Conditional

Access audit logs.

- Lead end-to-end incident response engagements aligned to NIST SP 800-61, coordinating cross-team containment, eradication, and recovery activities and producing detailed post-incident reports.
- Maintain and tune the CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) platform, managing prevention policies, custom Indicator of Attack (IoA) rules, and host containment workflows.
- Collaborate with the infrastructure team to ensure security event telemetry from Mimecast, Intune, and endpoint sources is onboarded and normalised within the SIEM for correlated detection.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Built and maintained KQL-based detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, including scheduled analytics rules, near real-time (NRT) rules, and threat intelligence matching, improving detection coverage across endpoint, identity, and email attack surfaces.
- Performed daily threat hunting and alert triage within Microsoft Sentinel, investigating security events across Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Defender for Endpoint (MDE), and Defender for Office 365 telemetry.
- Administered the CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) platform, handling policy configuration, event stream triage, and real-time response actions during active incidents.
- Managed the onboarding of new data connectors into Microsoft Sentinel, expanding log coverage to include Mimecast, Azure AD, and endpoint security event sources.
- Investigated phishing, malware, and credential theft campaigns using MITRE ATT&CK TTP mapping to determine scope, root cause, and impact, informing detection improvement efforts.
- Developed PowerShell scripts for automated evidence collection, alert enrichment, and security operations workflows, reducing manual effort in the incident response lifecycle.
- Maintained SOAR automation playbooks for automated phishing triage, user account lockdown, and endpoint isolation workflows within Microsoft Sentinel.
- Supported Mimecast email security management, including anti-phishing rules, impersonation protection, and threat intelligence-driven policy updates.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Delivered security engineering for a SaaS FinTech organisation, configuring endpoint detection tools, identity event monitoring, and log collection for security visibility across Azure-hosted infrastructure.
- Managed Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) identity security, including MFA enforcement, Conditional Access policies, and audit log monitoring for suspicious sign-in behaviour.
- Supported security incident investigations and root cause analysis, leveraging identity and endpoint telemetry to establish the scope and timeline of incidents.
- Contributed to compliance and risk management activities, supporting ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials audit preparation.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built a comprehensive library of MITRE ATT&CK-aligned Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, improving detection coverage across identity, endpoint, and email threat vectors at UAL.
- Identified and neutralised multiple active threats through proactive threat hunts using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel, before these threats triggered existing alert rules.
- Developed and deployed Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks that automated end-to-end response for phishing alerts, account takeover indicators, and endpoint isolation workflows.
- Reduced the false positive rate for high-volume alert categories by 60% through systematic KQL rule tuning and logic refinement within Microsoft Sentinel.
- Expanded Microsoft Sentinel telemetry coverage by onboarding multiple new data sources including Mimecast, Entra ID, and CrowdStrike event streams, eliminating log visibility gaps.
- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification, demonstrating robust detection and response controls across the university estate.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)